

Forgiving Is Not the Same as Trusting

25–30 min · Week 17 · ★★ HIGHEST RISK · Counselor On-Site

OBJECTIVE	Students distinguish between forgiveness (an inner choice for their own peace) and trust (a between-people thing that must be earned), and articulate that forgiving someone does not mean staying close to them.
CASEL FOCUS	Social Awareness · relationship judgment; Relationship Skills: discernment about closeness
VOCABULARY	forgive · trust · earn · inside · between people · not the same · never owed
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet · Forgiveness vs. Trust anchor chart · scenario cards (Unit 3 Lesson 3 cards) · COUNSELOR PHYSICALLY ON-SITE FULL LESSON

SAFETY CHECK

★★ HIGHEST RISK — COUNSELOR PHYSICALLY ON-SITE THE FULL LESSON. NO EXCEPTIONS. This lesson explicitly affirms students do NOT have to be close to people who have hurt them. Some students may be in situations where this affirmation comes as new information — and may be relieved or distressed. CRITICAL: forgiveness is NEVER required when someone is still hurting them. State this explicitly multiple times. Crisis resources visible: 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline · Crisis Text Line: HOME to 741741.

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Show the two-truths chart from Lesson 2. "Last lesson: understand the why AND name the hurt. Today: even if I forgive someone — do I have to be close to them again?*"

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"Someone hurt me. I am thinking about forgiving them — for ME. But I do not feel safe being close to them anymore. Is that okay?"

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 4



Two Different Things

5 MIN

Frame the central distinction: "Forgiveness and trust are two DIFFERENT things. Forgiveness is INSIDE — it is for YOUR peace. Trust is BETWEEN people — it is about safety. You can give forgiveness alone. You cannot give trust alone — the other person has to EARN it back.**"